

Yunyan Zhao

Department of Psychology | University of Notre Dame
(574) 210-3116 | yzhao27@nd.edu | [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

- 2022-Present Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Psychology, University of Notre Dame
Advisor: Dr. Jenny Padilla
- 2022 M.Ed. in Psychology, Collaborative Innovation Center of Assessment toward Basic Education Quality, Beijing Normal University
Advisor: Dr. Fumei Chen
Thesis: “Sibling relationship in Chinese adolescents: Its characteristics, and the influence of interparental conflict and parental favoritism”
- 2019 B.A. in Psychology, Central China Normal University
Advisor: Dr. Xiaojun Sun

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Zhao, Y.,** & Padilla, J. (2026). Marital conflict and youth adjustment in Mexican-origin families: The moderating role of sibling closeness. Manuscript accepted for publication in *Journal of Family Psychology*.
- Wang, Y. S., Su, X. T., Ke, L., He, Q. H., Chang, D., Nie, J., ..., **Zhao, Y.,** ... & Zuo, X. N. (2024). Initiating PeriCBD to probe perinatal influences on neurodevelopment during 3–10 years in China. *Scientific Data*, 11(1), 463. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-02199-z>
- Li, Z., **Zhao, Y.,** He, R., Luo, R., Luo, Y., Yang, Z., ... & Chen, F. (2024). An integrated model: marital effect on adolescent behavioral problems through siblings. *Frontiers in psychology*, 14, 1282092. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1282092>
- Luo, R., Chen, F., Ke, L., Wang, Y., **Zhao, Y.,** & Luo, Y. (2023). Interparental conflict and depressive symptoms among Chinese adolescents: A longitudinal moderated mediation model. *Development and Psychopathology*, 35(2), 972-981. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0954579422000190>
- Chen, F., **Zhao, Y.,** Luo, R., He R., & Luo, Y. (2023). Parent-Adolescent Discrepancies in Family Intimacy and Adolescent Loneliness and Aggression: A Response Surface Analysis. *Journal of Psychological Science*, 46(4), 873-880. <https://doi.org/10.16719/j.cnki.1671-6981.202304014>
- Wang, Y. S., Su, X. T., Ke, L., He, Q. H., Chang, D., Nie, J., ..., **Zhao, Y.,** ... & Zuo, X. N. (2023). A resource for probing influences of perinatal factors on neurodevelopment in 3-10-years-old Chinese children. *bioRxiv*. <https://doi.org/10.1101/2023.09.12.556724>
- Zhao, Y.,** Chen, F., Yuan, C., Luo, R., Ma, X., & Zhang, C. (2021). Parental favoritism and mobile phone addiction in Chinese adolescents: The role of sibling relationship and gender difference. *Children and Youth Services Review*, 120, 105766. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.childyouth.2020.105766>
- Zhao, Y.,** Yu, L., Lian, S., Yao, L., & Sun, X. (2021). The effect of passive social network sites (“SNSs”) use on adolescents’ body image depression: The mediating role of appearance-

related comparison and appearance self-discrepancy. *Psychological Development and Education* (01), 34-45. <https://doi.org/10.16187/j.cnki.issn1001-4918.2021.01.05>

Ma, X., Chen, F., Luo, R., **Zhao Y.**, & Wang Y. (2020). Mechanisms of Marital Intimacy in the Relationship Between Child Problem Behaviors and Parental Parenting Stress. *Studies of Psychology and Behavior* (06), 762-769. <https://doi.org/CNKI:SUN:CLXW.0.2020-06-011>

Manuscripts under Review

Zhao, Y., Padilla, J., Yao, L., & Sun, X. Passive social network sites use, peer, and restrained eating in Chinese college girls: Integrating the sociocultural and attachment theory.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Zhao, Y., & Padilla, J. Latent profiles of sibling relationship qualities among Mexican-origin adolescents: Associations with friendship dynamics.

Zhao, Y., & Padilla, J. Latent Profiles of parent involvement in school: Associations with adolescents' educational aspirations, expectations, and utility.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Zhao, Y., Padilla, J. (2025, May). *Latent Profiles of Sibling Relationship Qualities Among Mexican-Origin Adolescents: Associations with Friendships Dynamics*. Paper symposium presented at the 2025 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.

Zhao, Y., Padilla, J., Yao, L., & Sun, X. (2024, June). *Passive Social Network Sites Use, Peer Attachment, and Restrained Eating in Chinese College Girls: Integrating the Sociocultural and Attachment Theory*. Poster presented at the 27th Biennial Meeting of the International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development, Lisbon, Portugal.

Zhao, Y., Padilla, J., Updegraff, K., & Umaña-Taylor A. (2024, April). *Marital Conflict and Youth Adjustment in Mexican-origin Families: Moderating Role of Sibling Intimacy*. Poster presented at the Biennial Society for Research in Adolescence Conference, Chicago, IL.

Zhao, Y., Chen, F., Luo, R., & Luo, Y. (2021, October). *Parent-Adolescent Discrepancies in Family Intimacy and Adolescent Problem Behaviors: A Response Surface Analysis*. Paper presented at the 23rd National Academic Conference of Psychology in Huhehaote, China.

Luo R., **Zhao Y.**, He R., Wang Y., & Chen F. (2021, October). *The Characteristics of Parental Favoritism in Two-child Families and Its Relationship with Adolescents' Behavior Problems*. Paper presented at the 23rd National Academic Conference of Psychology in Huhehaote, China.

Zhao, Y., Yu, L., Lian, S., Yao L., & Sun, X. (2018, November), *The effect of passive social network sites ("SNSs") use on adolescents' body image depression: The mediating role of appearance-related comparison and appearance self-discrepancy*. Paper presented at the 21st National Academic Conference of Psychology in Beijing, China.

Yu, L., **Zhao Y.**, Chai, H., Lian, S., & Sun, X. (2018, November). *Relationship between cognitive overload in social networking sites and sleep quality of adolescents: The mediating role of core self-evaluations*. Paper presented at the 21st National Academic Conference of Psychology in Beijing, China.

REVIEW EXPERIENCE

Ad-hoc Reviewer

- Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology
- Psychology of Popular Media

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025 Spring	“Adolescent development, social media, and body image”, Guest lecturer for Professor Jenny Padilla’s Developmental Psychology course, University of Notre Dame (<i>March 16</i>)
2025 Spring	Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology, University of Notre Dame – “Developmental Psychology” (Dr. Jenny Padilla)
2024 Fall	Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology, University of Notre Dame – “Statistics for Behavioral Sciences” (Dr. Guangjian Zhang)
2024 Spring	Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology, University of Notre Dame – “Methods for Behavioral Sciences” (Dr. Kathleen Eberhard)
2023 Fall	Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology, University of Notre Dame – “Methods for Behavioral Sciences” (Dr. Jordyn Wilcox)
2021 Spring	Teaching Assistant, Collaborative Innovation Center of Assessment for Basic education center, BNU – “Interpersonal Relationship Network and Child and Adolescent Development” (Dr. Fumei Chen)

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

2026	Graduate Student Professional Development Award (\$2500.00)
2026	Graduate Student Research Award (\$5000)
2025-2026	Notre Dame Wilsey Distinguished Graduate Fellowships
2025	Excellence in Scholarly Research Award, University of Notre Dame
2025	Graduate Student Research Award (\$4000)
2025	Shaheen Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition People’s Choice Award, University of Notre Dame (\$1500)
2025	Graduate Student Professional Development Award (\$906)
2024-2025	Notre Dame CSC Justice Fellowship
2024	Graduate Student Professional Development Award (\$2339.22)
2022	Outstanding Graduate (5%), Beijing Normal University
2021	Best Teaching Assistant of 2021 Spring, Beijing Normal University
2021	Graduate Academic Innovation Award (\$700), Beijing Normal University
2017	Shuren Golden Scholarship (\$280), Central China Normal University
2016	National Encouragement Scholarship (\$700), Central China Normal University

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Data analysis

SPSS (proficient), MPlus (proficient), SAS (competent), R-Studio (competent), EQS (competent)

SERVICES

2023-2025 Graduate Advisory Committee, Psychology, University of Notre Dame
2023-2025 Graduate Orientation Team, University of Notre Dame
2024 Spring Graduate Resilience and Alliance at Notre Dame (GRAND) program
2022-present Initiative on Race and Resilience Affiliate, University of Notre Dame

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (Native)
English (advanced reading, spoken, written)